

The lowest electricity burden in the EU?

Testing a ministry claim about household electricity prices against Eurostat and the IMF

THE CLAIM UNDER REVIEW

“...the burden on Maltese families is the lowest in the EU, at 14.33 PPS per 100kWh.”

Ministry for the Environment, Energy and Public Cleanliness, 6 May 2025.
Based on Eurostat figures for the second half of 2024.

VERDICT: LARGELY SUPPORTED

Accurate figures; the subsidy cost is left out

TL;DR

On 6 May 2025 the Energy Ministry said that “**Malta has the lowest electricity prices for domestic consumers in the European Union when measured in terms of purchasing power standards**”, and that “the burden on Maltese families is the lowest in the EU, at 14.33 PPS per 100kWh”. We checked every figure against Eurostat and looked at what keeps the price low.

- 1

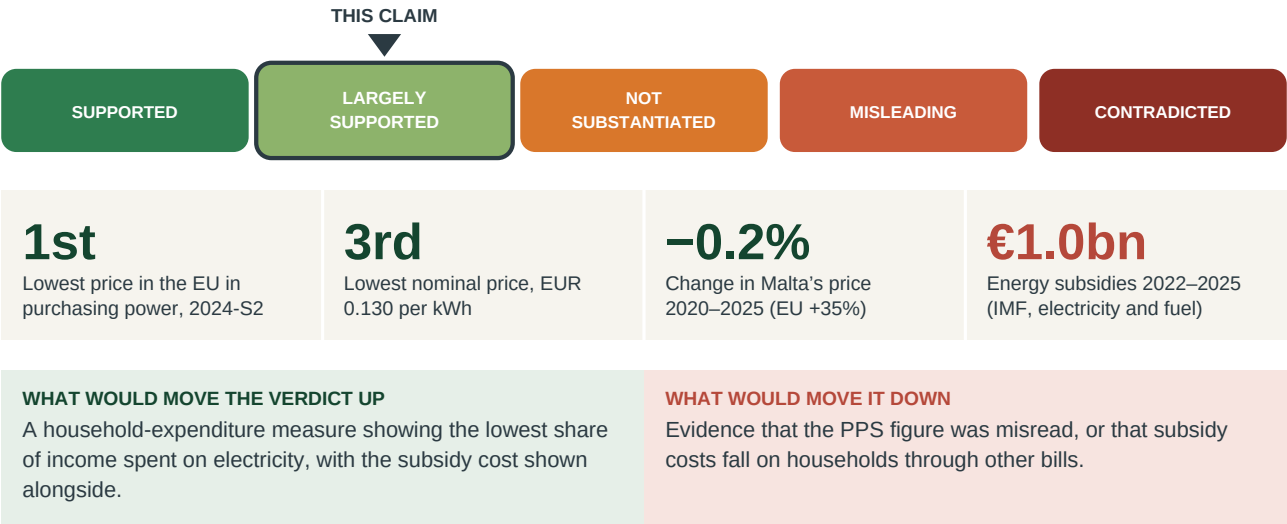
Every figure checks out. Eurostat now shows Malta at 14.35 PPS per 100 kWh in the second half of 2024, the lowest of 27 countries; the nominal price of EUR 0.130 is the third lowest; the Czech, Cypriot and German figures match exactly.
- 2

Prices really were stable. Malta’s household price was flat between 2020 and 2025 (–0.2%) while the EU average rose 35%.
- 3

The price is held down with public money. Tariffs have been frozen since 2014. The IMF puts energy subsidies (electricity and fuel) at 1.8% of GDP in 2022, falling to about 0.8% in 2025: roughly EUR 1 billion over four years, paid through public finances. The IMF recommends phasing out untargeted subsidies.
- 4

Few households struggle with bills. 7.6% of people cannot keep their home adequately warm (EU 8.8%) and 4.5% are in arrears on utility bills (EU 7.0%).
- 5

Verdict: largely supported (high confidence). The comparison is accurate. “Burden” is measured by price only; the cost of keeping that price low falls on the state budget, which the release does not mention.



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1 The claim

The press release by the Ministry for the Environment, Energy and Public Cleanliness was read in full [1].

What was said	Access
“Malta has the lowest electricity prices for domestic consumers in the European Union when measured in terms of purchasing power standards (PPS)... for the second half of 2024.”	Read in full
“...third-lowest nominal electricity price... at €0.131 per unit... the burden on Maltese families is the lowest in the EU, at 14.33 PPS per 100kWh.” Czech Republic 41.00, Cyprus 35.70, Germany 35.23 PPS.	Read in full
“This is clear confirmation that our policy is working for the benefit of the people.” (Minister Miriam Dalli)	Read in full

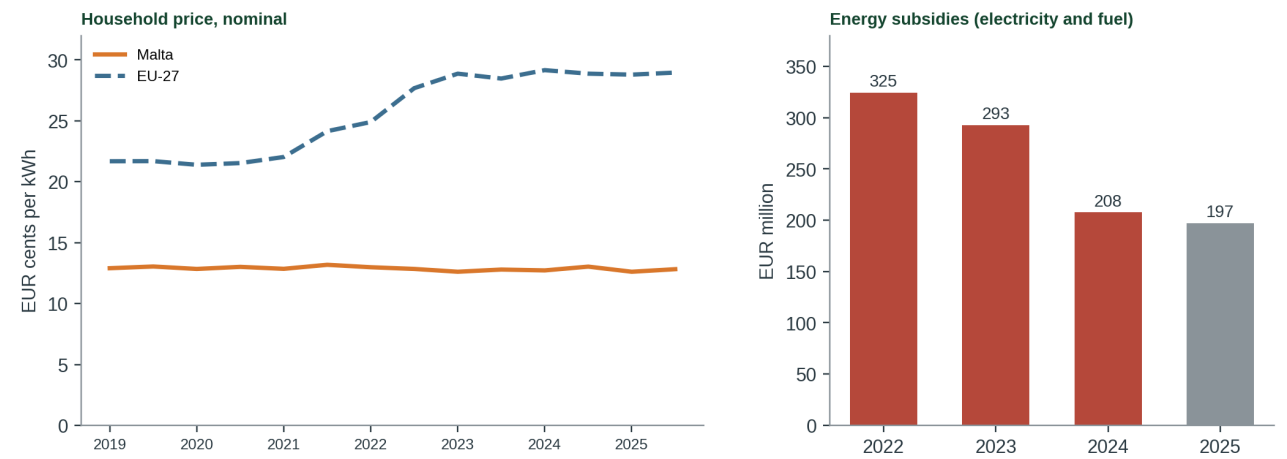
2 Method

Eurostat household electricity prices (band DC, all taxes) for all EU countries, 2019–2025, in euros and purchasing power standards [2]; Eurostat energy-poverty indicators [3]; energy subsidies from the IMF’s 2025 Article IV report [4], converted to euros with Eurostat GDP. Numbers are recomputed by *tools/cc-022-report/calc.py*. Official statistics and assessments are grade C.

3 What the data show



Figure 1. Household electricity prices in the EU, second half of 2024. Malta is third cheapest in euros and cheapest once prices are adjusted for purchasing power.



Left: Eurostat nrg_pc_204. Right: IMF Country Report 26/29, Table 2 (% of GDP; 2025 grey = projection) x Eurostat nominal GDP.

Figure 2. Left: Malta’s price stayed flat while the EU average rose. Right: what that stability cost in energy subsidies.

Indicator	Claim	Eurostat / IMF	Grade
Malta, PPS per 100 kWh, 2024-S2	14.33, lowest	14.35, lowest of 27	C
Malta, nominal price, 2024-S2	EUR 0.131, third lowest	EUR 0.1303, third lowest	C
Czechia / Cyprus / Germany, PPS	41.00 / 35.70 / 35.23	41.00 / 35.70 / 35.23	C
Price change 2020-S1 → 2025-S2	“remained stable”	Malta -0.2%; EU +35.4%	C
Energy subsidies 2022–2025	not mentioned	EUR 325m, 293m, 208m, 197m	C
Unable to keep home warm, 2025	–	7.6% (EU 8.8%)	C
Arrears on utility bills, 2025	–	4.5% (EU 7.0%)	C

All values in data/cc-022/checks.csv.

4

Where the evidence points different ways

Q1 Is the burden on families the lowest in the EU?

ON PRICE, YES

EVIDENCE FOR THE CLAIM'S IMPRESSION

Price adjusted for purchasing power is the lowest in the EU, and fewer Maltese than average struggle to pay bills or heat their homes.

EVIDENCE AGAINST

PPS adjusts for general price levels, not for how much electricity households use or their income; it is a price comparison, not a measure of burden.

WHY THEY DIFFER, AND WHAT IT MEANS HERE

For this claim: as a statement about price, it is accurate.

Q2 Is it confirmation that the policy works?

INCOMPLETE

EVIDENCE FOR THE CLAIM'S IMPRESSION

Prices stayed flat through the 2022 energy shock, protecting households.

EVIDENCE AGAINST

The stability was bought with energy subsidies of about EUR 1 billion in 2022–2025 [4], paid through public finances; the IMF recommends replacing untargeted subsidies with cost-recovery tariffs and targeted support.

WHY THEY DIFFER, AND WHAT IT MEANS HERE

For this claim: the release presents the benefit without its cost.

5

Testing the claim

Sub-claim	What the evidence shows	Rating
A. Lowest price in PPS, 2024-S2	Confirmed by Eurostat [2].	SUPPORTED
B. Third-lowest nominal price; comparison figures	Confirmed [2].	SUPPORTED
C. Prices stable since 2020	−0.2% vs EU +35% [2].	SUPPORTED
D. Lowest “burden” on families	True for price; the subsidy cost is not counted [4].	LARGELY SUPPORTED

6

Verdict and requests for evidence

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

Every figure is accurate; the cost of keeping prices low is left out. Confidence: high.

Why. The statistical claims match Eurostat exactly. The word “burden” and the minister’s conclusion rest on price alone, while the tariff freeze is financed by public subsidies the IMF puts at about EUR 1 billion over 2022–2025. That omission qualifies the claim without contradicting it.

Evidence we are asking for

- ☐ The electricity-only subsidy to Enemalta by year, separate from fuel.
- ☐ Household spending on electricity as a share of income, by income group.

7

Limitations

- The IMF subsidy series covers electricity and fuel; 2025 is a staff projection.
- Band DC is a typical household; very large or very small users face different prices.
- Eurostat revised Malta's PPS figure from 14.33 to 14.35 after the release; the ranking is unchanged.

References

- [1] Ministry for the Environment, Energy and Public Cleanliness (6 May 2025). Electricity prices in the EU: Maltese households with lowest burden. PR250746en. <https://www.gov.mt/en/Government/DOI/Press%20Releases/Pages/2025/05/06/pr250746en.aspx>
- [2] Eurostat. nrg_pc_204, electricity prices for household consumers; retrieved 4 Oct 2026. https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/databrowser/view/nrg_pc_204/default/table
- [3] Eurostat. ilc_mdex01, ilc_mdex07; retrieved 4 Oct 2026. https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/databrowser/view/ilc_mdex01/default/table
- [4] International Monetary Fund (2026). Malta: 2025 Article IV Consultation. Country Report 26/29, Table 2 and para. on energy subsidies. <https://www.imf.org/-/media/files/publications/cr/2026/english/1mltea2026001-source-pdf.pdf>
- [5] Miżien. Data and calculations: data/cc-022/; tools/cc-022-report/.

Appendix A: series standards and verdict scale

Every investigation in this series follows the same rules so that verdicts are comparable and challengeable.

Verdict	Meaning
SUPPORTED	Evidence consistently backs the claim as stated.
LARGELY SUPPORTED	Backed by the evidence, with minor caveats that do not change the substance.
NOT SUBSTANTIATED	Stated more strongly than the evidence offered or available allows. May be true in some conditions but has not been shown.
MISLEADING	Omits material facts so that the overall impression is inaccurate, even if individual statements are defensible.
CONTRADICTED	The available evidence points against the claim.

Confidence

High: multiple independent lines of evidence agree. **Moderate:** evidence is relevant but incomplete or indirect. **Low:** evidence is thin, second-hand or conflicting.

Evidence grades

A experiment · B observational study with a control or gradient · C review, guidance or official statistics · D assertion or anecdote.

Standards

- **Quote the speaker, not the headline**, with outlet and date, and link the original where possible.
- **Separate the claim from the evidence offered for it**, and say who made which statement.
- **Grade the evidence** and show differing views side by side where the evidence is unsettled.
- **State what we could not access or verify**, and what would change the verdict either way.
- **Ask for the missing evidence** in specific, answerable requests.
- **Offer a right of reply** before wider circulation and append responses.
- **Correct errors openly** with a version number and change log.
- **Whistle-blow only on evidence:** a verdict of *Misleading* or *Contradicted* requires documents or data that can be shown, not inference.
- **Check every side.** Government, opposition, NGOs and developers are held to the same standard.

Appendix B: revision log

Version	Date	Change
1.0	4 Oct 2026	First issue. Right of reply to the Energy Ministry not yet sent.